

The Noble Sūtra Called 'The Seizure of Radiance Reversed'

Ārya Ojahpratyaṅgiraṇī Sūtra · Toh 618 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་མདངས་ཡུའི་འཕགྲོ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའམིད།

Toh 618 in the Kangyur is a short canonical sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Ojahpratyaṅgiraṇī Sūtra and in Tibetan as the Phags pa mdangs phyir 'phrog pa, meaning "The Noble Sūtra Called The Seizure of Radiance Reversed." It belongs to the class of dhāraṇī or vidyā-mantra texts, presenting a protective formula spoken directly by the Buddha to his attendant Ānanda at Śrāvastī. The text's central concern is the preservation and restoration of personal radiance or vital luster, promising that whoever upholds, recites, or masters this vidyā mantra will be shielded from having their radiance seized, and will have it restored even if it has already been taken. As a brief sūtra of this protective and apotropaic character, it sits within the broader collection of dhāraṇī texts found in the Kangyur.

Translated and edited, and revised in accordance with the new terminology and finalized.

In the language of India: Ārya Ojahpratyaṅgiraṇī Sūtra.

In the Tibetan language: the noble sūtra called "The Seizure of Radiance Reversed."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was residing at Śrāvastī. Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, receive this vidyā mantra of Reversing the Seizure of Radiance. Memorize it. Contain it fully. Make it completely perfect.

Ānanda, whoever upholds, teaches, recites, or makes completely perfect this vidyā mantra of Reversing the Seizure of Radiance — their radiance will not be seized, and it will not come to be seized. And even if it has been seized, it will once again be restored completely intact."

Then at that time the Blessed One proclaimed these root mantras:

Tadyathā: phi phi le phi le me, phi lu meṃ ge, phi lu ma hi, balgu ma ti, sāra ba ti, kṣira ba ti, ku ru māti, u ta ba la ni, go ri, gandhari, cauri, caṇḍali, sture stu ba re, indra māli ni, ja la ni, so bāke tri kṣoṣa me sāgare, mahā sāgare,

phuru tse, phuru tsure, sane mane, da ba phe, da dam pa phe, hulu hulu
svāhā.

When this vidyā mantra was proclaimed, this world-realm of the great trichiliocosm shook, shook greatly, shook throughout, shook throughout and greatly, and proceeded even to being disturbed, greatly disturbed, and utterly and greatly disturbed throughout. And the yakṣas (Skt. yakṣa) cried out and gave forth a great cry with a great voice, saying: "Alas, the suffering! Alas, the anguish!" and they fell prostrate.

"By the truth and truthful words by which I, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly awakened buddha Śākyamuni, have spoken this vidyā mantra of Reversing the Seizure of Radiance — by that truth and those truthful words let me protect them. Let it be for their welfare and happiness. Let their radiance be seized back. Let it be restored. Let it be accomplished nearby.

Whether one is seized by a yakṣa or held by a human or a non-human — at that very time, at that very measure, in that very instant, the radiance is seized back, it is not seized away again, and it fully enters in. But if the radiance is seized and not restored — if, while remaining and dwelling thus without being destroyed, one should wish to destroy it further or wish to seize it again — such a one will have displeased the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, together with the assembly of śrāvakas."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Ānanda rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The noble Mahāyāna sūtra called "The Seizure of Radiance Reversed" is concluded.

Translator's Notes

- The title term translated as "Reversing the Seizure of Radiance" renders the Tibetan རྒྱལ་བུ་རྩིས་ཀྱི་འགོད་པ།, which literally means "seizing back the radiance" or "counter-seizure of radiance." The Sanskrit title Ārya Ojahpratyaṅgiraṇī confirms this: ojas means vital radiance or life-force, and pratyaṅgiraṇī means "seizing back" or "counter-seizure." The sūtra belongs to the genre of protective dhāraṇī texts concerned with theft of vital energy by non-human beings. The phrase "Reversing the Seizure of Radiance" has been used throughout to capture both the protective and restorative function of the ritual. The mantra syllables are rendered as phonetic transliterations and are not translated, consistent with standard practice for dhāraṇī literature.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.